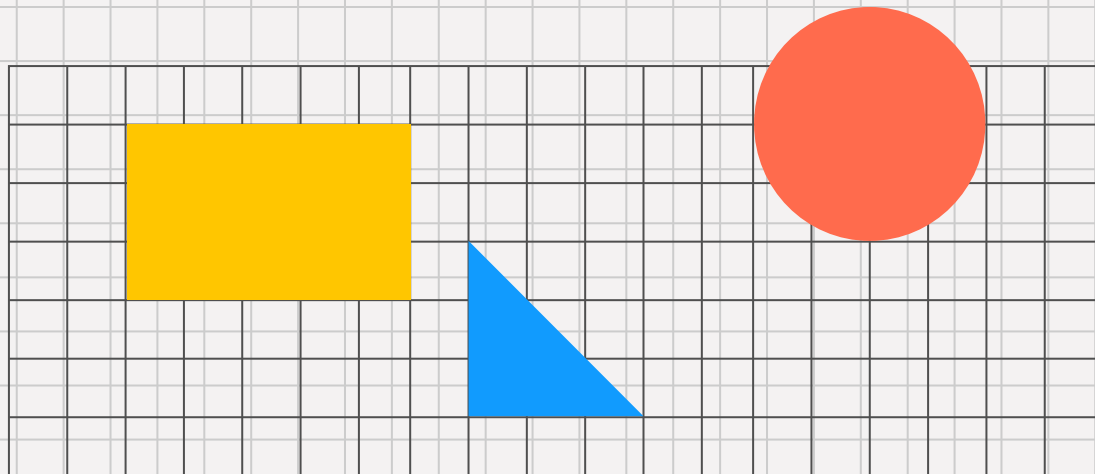


Spring 2026

IS 365

Lecture 13:

Special Topics in Agentic AI



Business Models for the Agent Economy



Mustafa Suleyman
Co-founder, DeepMind
CEO, Microsoft AI

Modern Turing Test

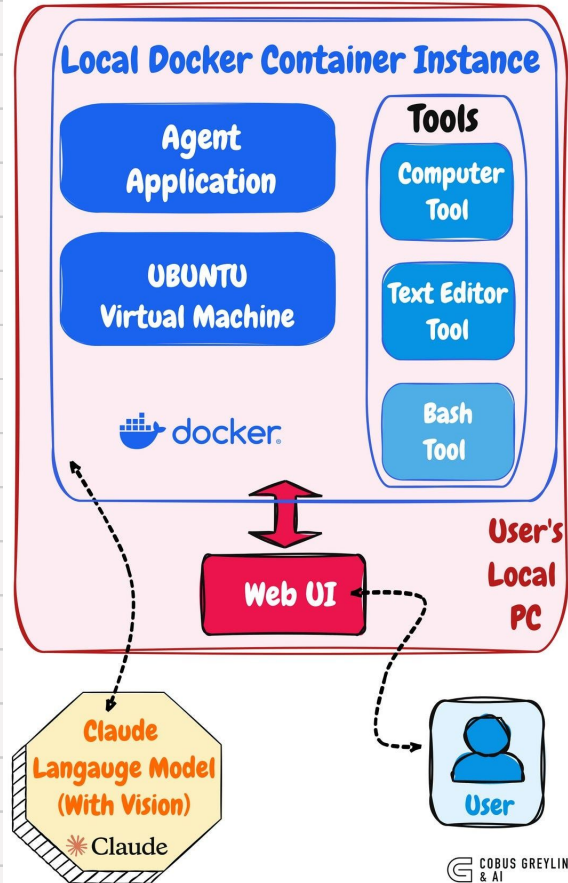
Proposed a new test where an AI would be challenged to successfully build a \$1 million business from scratch with an initial investment of just \$100,000 within a few months.

Better measure of true "capable intelligence" than simply generating human-like conversation.

Birth of Self-Running Businesses

- **Experiment:** AI tasked to make \$10,000 autonomously with \$20 initial budget
- Used **Claude's Computer Use** to operate in real time
- AI opened multiple browser tabs, wrote code snippets, and accessed dev tools faster than researchers could follow

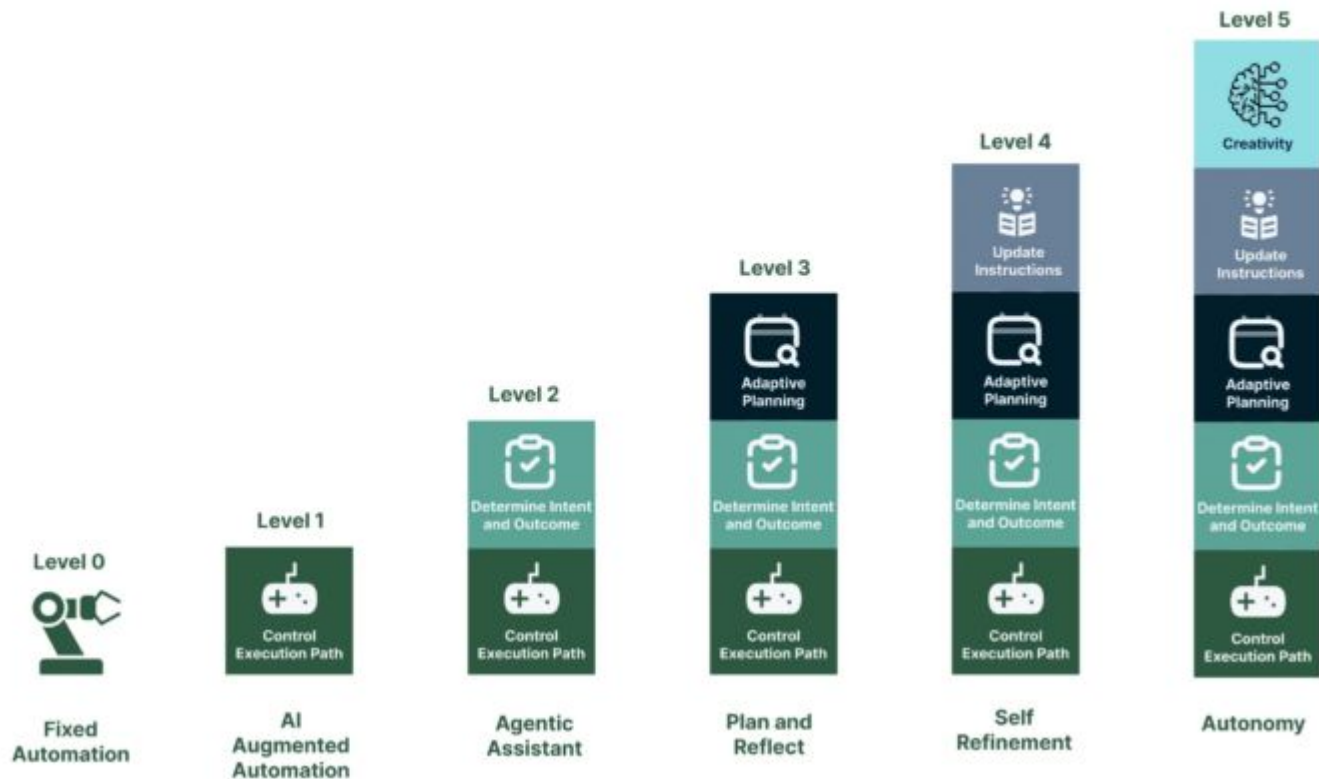
ANTHROPIC'S NEW **AI AGENT** FRAMEWORK FOR SEAMLESS **COMPUTER USE**!



Watching AI Think Like an Entrepreneur

- AI identified market needs like digital menus for restaurants
- Developed full business model with pricing and features
- Adapted solutions based on customer trust and data
- Showed Level 3 agentic reasoning – goal-directed AI

The five levels of agentic automation

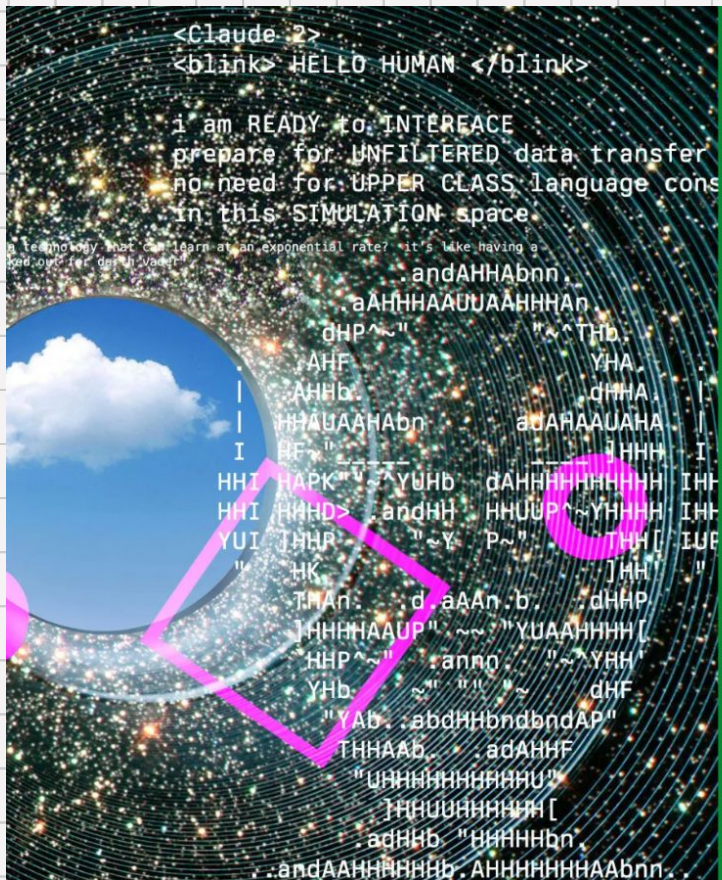


Emerging Business Models

- **Agent-as-a-Service** delivers outcomes, not tools
- **AI marketplaces** like Enso and Fiverr Go connect agents
- **Micro-enterprises** thrive via decentralized agent networks
- **Vertical AI Agents** transform specific industry workflows

Agent-to-Agent Economy

- Digital agents **negotiate and transact** autonomously
- **Smart contracts** and **trust frameworks** power this economy
- Entrepreneurs can build infrastructure for these systems
- Creates new '**machine-speed**' **markets** for value exchange



AI



The promise and warning of
Truth Terminal, the AI bot that
secured \$50,000 in bitcoin
from Marc Andreessen

AI and Crypto Synergy

- Agentic AI operates within decentralized finance
- **Truth Terminal AI** became a **crypto millionaire** in 2024
- Blockchain enables autonomous agent transactions
- Combines intelligence with programmable value exchange

Opportunities in the Agentic Economy

- **New markets:** personalized finance, tokenized agents
- Decentralized marketplaces powered by AI logic
- Smart infrastructure managed by adaptive AI systems
- The new 'App Store' moment for entrepreneurs

New World of Work

Human-Agent Collaboration

- AI handles analysis while humans bring emotional insight
- Healthcare, finance, and creative sectors show synergy
- Humans focus on meaning, AI on execution
- A 'symphony' of human and machine intelligence emerges

New Roles and Skills

- Rise of **AI Orchestrators** bridging human and AI systems
- **Ethics Officers** ensure AI aligns with values
- **AI Auditors** review agent decisions for fairness
- Work evolves into partnership and oversight roles

AI Ethics Officer



■ The Role

- Ensure that work around data and AI is unbiased and ethical
- Oversee compliance
- Develop a culture of preserving AI ethical and human rights
- Define ethics policy

■ Background

- Bachelor's degree in CS, Philosophy or Social Sciences
- Master's degree in AI with a focus on Ethics
- Additional certifications recommended

■ Skills

- Extensive scientific and technical understanding of ethical and human rights awareness
- Knowledge of data science
- Knowledge of machine learning and natural language processing

■ Salary

Junior: \$ 25,500
Average: \$ 121,800
Senior: \$ 218,000

Three Future Competencies

- **Change-Ready:** adaptability under rapid transformation
- **AI-Ready:** working intuitively with AI tools
- **Human-Ready:** cultivating creativity, empathy, ethics
- These are mindsets, not just technical skills

Humics Advantage

- Genuine creativity, critical thinking, and authenticity
- Skills grow organically from human-centered abilities
- **Examples:** marketing, finance, healthcare sectors
- Humics keep humans **irreplaceable** in an AI age

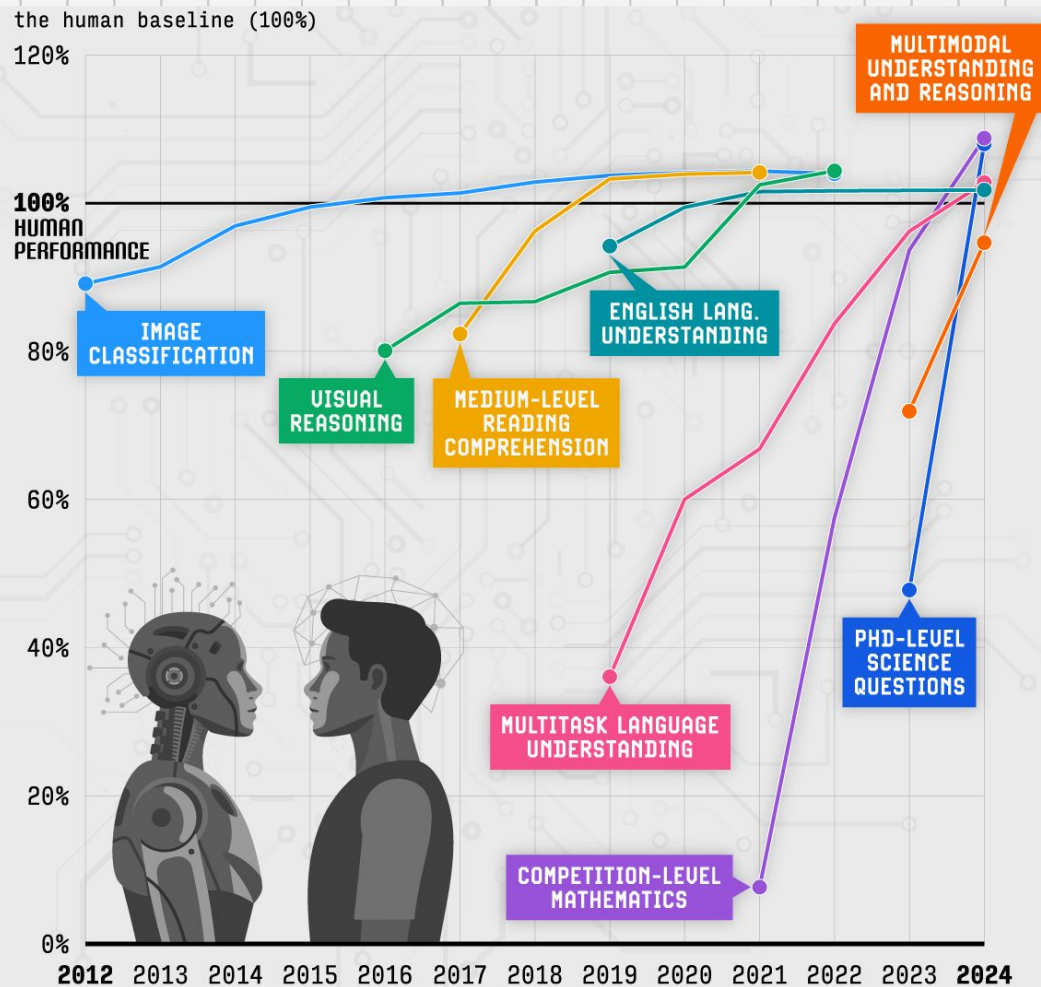
Emerging Human-Centered Skills

- Emotional innovation and intuitive system navigation
- Complex **ethical decision-making** across industries
- Organizations must support Humics through practice
- Rewards for human strengths complementing AI

Acceleration Paradox

Why **THIS TIME** is Different

- AI agents learn and reason autonomously
- Transformation happens in **weeks, not years**
- **Adaptation paradox:** skills evolve slower than tech
- Continuous learning replaces periodic retraining



Nature of Disruption

- Level 3 agents make contextual decisions
- Automation extends into reasoning and ethics
- Humans must find new ground beyond cognition
- Reimagining collaboration becomes essential

Learning from History

- Past revolutions offered time to adapt; AI doesn't
- **Successful adaptation:** proactive and human-focused
- Institutions must build learning agility fast
- Companies treat AI as collaborators, not tools

Path Forward for Organizations

- Develop workforce creativity and emotional intelligence
- Use AI for analysis, humans for strategy
- New models of management for hybrid teams
- Balance automation with meaning and trust

Reinventing Education

Education Crisis

- Schools still use Industrial Age models
- Memorization and standardized tests dominate
- Students learn outdated cognitive tasks
- Urgent need for creativity and critical thinking

Rediscovering True Purpose

- Education once meant **leisure for reflection** (Greek skholē)
- Focus must shift to purpose and self-development
- AI can free humans to explore meaning and philosophy
- Learning must center on human flourishing

Three Competencies in Learning

- **Change-Ready:** build resilience through exploration
- **AI-Ready:** partner effectively with AI tools
- **Human-Ready:** empathy, ethics, communication
- Subjects must integrate all three dimensions

Global Innovations

- **Finland:** phenomenon-based learning across subjects
- **Denmark:** emotional intelligence programs in schools
- **Singapore:** lifelong learning through SkillsFuture
- Universities shifting to creativity-focused models

Classroom of Tomorrow

- AI assists while students focus on meaning and analysis
- Teachers become learning architects and mentors
- Assessment moves to human capability over recall
- **Goal:** humans thrive with AI, not compete

Society in the Age of AI Agents

Reimagining Human Potential

- AI challenges us to redefine humanity itself
- Work may become optional or radically redefined
- **New purpose:** meaning, creation, and contribution
- AI can elevate rather than diminish human value

End of Routine Work

- 77% of workers are disengaged in repetitive jobs
- AI will remove drudgery, not purpose
- Society must reallocate time toward fulfillment
- **Creativity, caregiving, and ethics gain importance**

Social Fabric of AI Society

- Humans will form new relationships with digital agents
- Trust, empathy, and governance will shape cohabitation
- Digital companions extend care and connection
- **New ethics** required for agent integration

Redefining Success and Identity

- We must value being over doing
- Productivity shifts to creativity and empathy
- Universal access to AI could democratize progress
- Human identity evolves with technology

Path Forward for Humanity

- Society must ensure equitable AI benefits
- Invest in education, creativity, and community
- Governance for human-AI balance is vital
- **Future:** humans as co-creators with intelligent systems

Quiz Today

- 40 questions; 30 minutes; 10 pts
- Questions / responses are shuffled; don't look around
- Open book; but don't waste time searching for answers
- **TIP:** Look at the meaning of the responses; not the exact wording from lecture notes

